

THE EXAMINER'S BENCH

Examination Notebook Field Test

Test whether light structure can support forensic thinking without crowding the page or pretending to replace the official record.

THE TEST

Use the sample through a real reasoning task. The structured pages should orient the work, then disappear. The open pages should feel generous enough that the notebook stops announcing its own design.

Before you print

- [] Print double-sided at 100 percent on paper close to the stock you would actually carry.
- [] Use fictitious or sanitized information unless your agency has approved the test.
- [] Try the pens you normally reach for, including gel, rollerball, and ballpoint.
- [] Judge the interior as a working object, not as a presentation PDF.
- [] Do not treat the prototype as an approved case notebook or records process.

Use the structured pages

Complete the case-orientation page, add several evidence sources, record two tool/version references, write open questions, and index at least one finding. Skip anything that does not help. A field that is repeatedly skipped may not deserve to exist.

Use the open pages

Spend at least twenty minutes mapping a real technical problem, outlining an examination path, or writing through an uncertainty. Try the ruled, margin, dot-grid, and nearly blank treatments. Notice which structure supports thought and which one keeps asking to be noticed.

Test re-entry

Leave the notebook closed for several hours. Return and use only the orientation, indexes, and your handwritten pages to reconstruct where the work stood and what question remained open.

Evaluation sheet

The notebook succeeds when it adds orientation at a few critical moments and gives the rest of the space back to the examiner.

TEST	NOTES	1-5
Orientation Did the front matter help you enter or re-enter the work?		
Structure Which fields earned their space, and which felt supervisory?		
Writing room Did the page feel open enough for diagrams, questions, and long notes?		
Ruling Which treatment best supported your normal thinking style?		
Pen response Note bleed-through, feathering, drag, and drying behavior.		
Record awareness Was the policy reminder useful, proportionate, and clear?		

Working-page preference

☐

Light ruled

☐

Ruled with margin

☐

Dot grid

☐

Nearly blank

☐

Mixed interior

Remove or rename: Add or enlarge: The page that felt most natural: Overall verdict:

☐

Continue this direction

☐

Reduce structure

☐

Rethink the format